

DAK GURU STUDY MATERIAL

Inspector of Posts / PS Group 'B' Examination

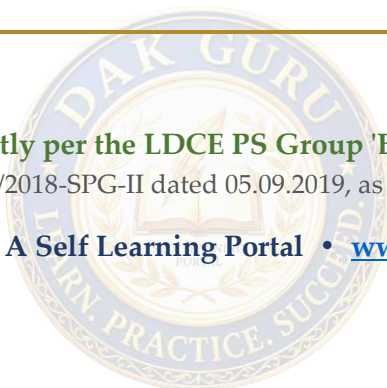
POSTAL MANUAL VOLUME II PAPER I

Organisation • Material Management • Office Procedure
Chapters I • VI • VIII • IX • XI • XII

Split strictly per the LDCE PS Group 'B' Syllabus

DoP letter No. 9-04/2018-SPG-II dated 05.09.2019, as corrected 30.12.2019

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DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate recent changes, amendments, notifications and this document is intended as a study aid only. Operational workflows are based on the APT application interface and departmental Standard Operating Procedures as compiled, and may be revised by the Department from time to time. Readers and aspirants are strongly advised to refer to official Department of Posts orders, SOPs, manuals and gazette notifications for the most reliable and authoritative position before relying on any provision herein.

Syllabus Map — What Paper I Demands

Postal Manual Volume II is split across BOTH papers of the LDCE. This booklet carries the Paper I chapters — complete. The companion volume carries Paper II (Chapters III, IV, V and VII).

Syllabus head (Paper I)	Vol II Chapter	Rules	Covered here
Organization of the Department	Chapter I — Organisation	1 onwards	Part A ✓
Material Management	Chapter VI — Stock (incl. Stationery)	269–385	Part B-1 ✓
Material Management	Chapter VIII — Printing	405–417	Part B-2 ✓
Material Management	Chapter IX — Contracts	418–431	Part B-3 ✓
Material Management	Chapter XII — Budget Estimates & Control	743 onwards	Part B-4 ✓
Office Procedure	Chapter XI — Miscellaneous Rules	611 onwards	Part C ✓

VERIFIED AGAINST THE OFFICIAL MANUAL — TWO CORRECTIONS

This edition has been checked against the **Postal Manual Volume II, Fourth Revised Edition** (Director General Posts). The official preface confirms **11 Chapters and 13 Appendices**, and that **Chapter II is deleted**.

1. Stationery is NOT a chapter. Earlier Dak Guru drafts carried a “Chapter 7 — Stationery”. The official text shows the stationery rules (341-A–385) run **inside Chapter VI (Stock)** — the page headers read “STOCK” right up to Rule 385, and Chapter VII begins at Rule 386 with an entirely different subject. Stationery is therefore **squarely in the Paper I syllabus as part of Chapter VI**, and has been folded in where it belongs.

2. Chapter VIII (Printing) is now included in full (Rules 405–417), from the official text. The earlier gap is closed.

NOTE ON THE SYLLABUS ITSELF

Source: DoP letter **No. 9-04/2018-SPG-II dated 05.09.2019**, as modified by the corrigendum of the same number **dated 30.12.2019** (Paper I item 1: “Consumer Protection Act, 1986” to be read as “2019”). A proposal to further amend the syllabus was circulated in **August 2022**; no revised syllabus traced as issued.

Cut-off rule: circulars / orders / guidelines / Rules issued **up to 31st December of the year preceding the examination** form part of the syllabus (except the Annual Report / Book of Information).

Watch this: Paper I also lists the **Indian Post Office Rules, 1933** under Inland/Foreign Post. Those Rules have been **superseded by the Post Office Rules, 2024** (G.S.R. 767(E), in force 16.12.2024). Not a Vol II item, but it affects your Paper I preparation.



Part A | Organisation of the Department

Syllabus: Postal Manual Volume II — Chapter I (Organization). How the Department is structured, from the Union Minister at the apex to the Circle, Region and Division — and the key administrative and training units.

Chapter I — Organisation

1. Organisational Structure

The Department of Posts (DoP), branded as **India Post**, functions under the **Ministry of Communications**, Government of India — one of the two Departments of the Ministry, the other being the Department of Telecommunications.

Political Executive

- **Minister of Communications** — the Cabinet Minister holding overall charge.
- **Minister of State for Communications** — assists the Cabinet Minister.

Administrative Head

- **Secretary (Posts)** — administrative head of the Department.
- **Director General Postal Services (DGPS)** — operational head of the postal network.
- **Chairperson, Postal Services Board** — heads the apex management body.

VERIFIED — READ THIS CAREFULLY

Older notes state these three are **one and the same person** — that reflects the historical arrangement, where the Secretary was ex-officio DG. As currently constituted, India Post's "Our Organisation" page lists the **Secretary, DoP & Chairperson, PSB** and the **Director General Postal Services** as **two distinct office-holders**. Safest line: Secretary = administrative head & Chairperson PSB; DG Postal Services = operational head. Treat the current Directorate org chart as authoritative.

2. Postal Services Board (PSB) — Chairperson + 7 Members

#	Member Portfolio	Remarks
1	Personnel	Establishment, cadre, discipline
2	Operations	Mail operations & delivery network
3	Technology	Technology & Estates
4	Financial Services	POSB, small savings, IPPB interface
5	HRD	Human Resource Development & training
6	Infrastructure	Buildings, estates, capital works

#	Member Portfolio	Remarks
7	Service Quality & Marketing	Customer satisfaction, philately, media

Two officers support the Board without being Members: the **Additional Secretary & Financial Advisor** (permanent invitee) and the **Secretary to the Board**.

STUDY NOTE — EARLIER VS CURRENT PORTFOLIOS

Older material listed a “Member (PLI)” and “Member (Planning & Marketing)”. PLI is now run as a separate **PLI Directorate** headed by a CGM. Quote the current seven portfolios.

3. Administrative Jurisdictions — 23 Postal Circles

VERIFIED

The number of Postal Circles is **23**. Andhra Pradesh and Telangana are separate Circles. There is additionally a **24th Circle — the Base Circle (Army Postal Service)** — counted separately from the 23 territorial Circles.

S.No	Circle	Headquarters	Jurisdiction / Coverage
1	Andhra Pradesh	Vijayawada	Andhra Pradesh
2	Assam	Guwahati	Assam
3	Bihar	Patna	Bihar
4	Chhattisgarh	Raipur	Chhattisgarh
5	Delhi	New Delhi	Delhi
6	Gujarat	Ahmedabad	Gujarat + Daman & Diu + Dadra & Nagar Haveli
7	Haryana	Ambala	Haryana
8	Himachal Pradesh	Shimla	Himachal Pradesh
9	J & K	Srinagar / Jammu	Jammu & Kashmir + Ladakh
10	Jharkhand	Ranchi	Jharkhand
11	Karnataka	Bengaluru	Karnataka
12	Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram	Kerala + Lakshadweep
13	Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal	Madhya Pradesh
14	Maharashtra	Mumbai	Maharashtra + Goa
15	North East	Shillong	Arunachal, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura
16	Odisha	Bhubaneswar	Odisha
17	Punjab	Chandigarh	Punjab + Chandigarh

S.No	Circle	Headquarters	Jurisdiction / Coverage
18	Rajasthan	Jaipur	Rajasthan
19	Tamil Nadu	Chennai	Tamil Nadu + Puducherry
20	Telangana	Hyderabad	Telangana
21	Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow	Uttar Pradesh
22	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Uttarakhand
23	West Bengal	Kolkata	West Bengal + Sikkim + Andaman & Nicobar Islands

BASE CIRCLE (ARMY POSTAL SERVICE)

Headed by an **Additional Director General, Army Postal Service** (rank of Major General). Officer cadre on deputation from the Civil Posts; **75% of other ranks** from the Department of Posts, **25% recruited by the Army**.

Field Hierarchy below the Circle

- **Region** — Postmaster General (PMG).
- **Division** — Postal or RMS Division, headed by SP/SSP or SRM/SSRM.
- **Sub-Division** — Inspector of Posts (IP) or ASP.
- **Post Offices** — Head Office (HO), Sub Office (SO), Branch Office (BO).

4. Key Administrative & Support Units

Unit	Details
Postal Stores Depots (PSD) / RPSD	Aligarh, Nashik, Bhubaneswar, Thrissur, Kolkata — procure, stock and supply forms, stationery, uniforms, locks, bags and stores
Security Printing Presses	Nashik (Maharashtra) & Hyderabad (Telangana) — postage stamps, postal stationery, security items
Zonal Returned Letter Offices	Kolkata (Eastern), Mumbai (Western), Lucknow (Northern), Chennai (Southern)

Postal Training Centres (PTC)

Training Institution	Location	PIN
RAKNPA (Rafi Ahmed Kidwai National Postal Academy)	Ghaziabad	201 002
Postal Training Centre	Guwahati	781 001
Postal Training Centre	Vadodara	390 001
Postal Training Centre	Mysuru	570 010

Training Institution	Location	PIN
Postal Training Centre	Madurai	625 022
Postal Training Centre	Saharanpur	247 002
Postal Training Centre	Darbhanga	846 005

MEMORY AID — PTC LOCATIONS

Apex academy = **RAKNPA, Ghaziabad**. Six PTCs — **Guwahati, Vadodara, Mysuru, Madurai, Saharanpur, Darbhanga**.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE — POST OFFICE ACT, 2023

The **Post Office Act, 2023** (Act 43 of 2023) repealed the **Indian Post Office Act, 1898**, in force **18 June 2024**. It removes the Government's exclusive privilege over letters, contains **no offences or penalties**, and runs to only 16 sections. Section 4 preserves the Post Office's exclusive privilege of issuing postage stamps. Under it, the **Post Office Rules, 2024** (in force 16.12.2024) supersede the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933.

Source: Post Office Act, 2023; Post Office Rules, 2024 (G.S.R. 767(E) dated 16.12.2024).



Part B | Material Management

Syllabus: Postal Manual Volume II — Chapter VI (Stock), Chapter VIII (Printing), Chapter IX (Contracts), Chapter XII (Budget Estimates and control). Read with Chapter 6 of the General Financial Rules, 2017, CVC guidelines on public procurement, and the Ministry of Finance manual on purchase of goods and services.

B-1. Chapter VI — Stock (Rules 269–385)

Rule 269-B. Classification of Stock

- **Dead Stock:** durable items such as plant, machinery, furniture and fixtures.
- **Stores:** consumable and perishable articles.

Inventories for both are maintained in the Stock Book (**Form S.K.-1**).

Rule 270. Locks and Keys

- **Repairs:** damaged or unserviceable locks must not be repaired locally — returned to the Depot.
- **Keys:** only one key is supplied with each lock.
- **Lost keys:** the lock is broken open and sent to the Depot for replacement; cost recovered from the official at fault.
- **Duplicate keys:** manufacturing or procuring duplicates locally is strictly prohibited.
- **Safe keys:** safes from private manufacturers come with one key; the duplicate is retained in the Depot.
- **Steel almirahs / cabinets:** manufacturer-provided duplicates are kept in the Divisional Office.

Rule 271. Custody of Duplicate Keys

- **Divisional Office custody:** duplicates of steel almirahs (other than the Head of Office's) are kept in the **joint custody** of the Office Supervisor / ASPO (HQ) and the Stock Assistant.
- **Head of Office keys:** the duplicate is sealed in an envelope bearing the Head of Office's **personal seal** and sent to the Circle Office for safe custody.
- **Retrieval:** issue of the duplicate must be authorised by the Divisional Officer, and sent by Insured Registered Parcel (insured for Rs. 100).

Rules 272–275. Stock Registers

Register	Form	Where maintained
General Stock Book	S.K.-1	Every office
Stock Register of Bags	S.K.-1(a)	Offices authorised by the Head of Circle
Forms Register (all varieties of forms)	S.K.-1(b)	As prescribed

Rule 277. Emergent Indents

- **Purpose:** urgent requirements between regular supply periods.
- **Frequency:** as and when needed, but ordinarily **not more than once a month**.
- **Submission:** in **triplicate**, using Form S.K.-2 or Form Genl.-18.

Rules 286–288. Supply of Forms

- **Schedule:** the Head of Circle prescribes **two six-monthly periods** for the supply of forms.
- **Master Schedule:** description of each form, average rate of consumption, total quantity for six months.
- **Wastage margin:** **2% departmental** and **10% public** (up to 15% for selected large offices in respect of public forms).
- **Review:** the Master Schedule is reviewed every 5 years.

Stationery (Rules 341-A–385) — within Chapter VI**PLACEMENT NOTE**

These rules were previously presented as a separate “Chapter 7”. The official Manual shows them running under the **STOCK** page-header through to Rule 385, with Chapter VII beginning at Rule 386. They are part of **Chapter VI** and therefore squarely examinable under Material Management.

Rule 341-A. Fixed Stationery Charges

Fixed stationery charges are allotted to offices and staff for procuring essential consumable items such as sealing wax, twine and glue, so that day-to-day work is not interrupted for want of small stores. Categories eligible:

- Cost of closing and sealing mail bags.
- Cost of candles and sealing wax.
- Cost of twine and rubber bands for bundles.

- Stationery charges for clerical staff, Mail Overseers and Mail Peons.

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE — MONETARY RATES

The specific rupee rates printed in older Manuals (e.g. Rs. 5 or Rs. 25) are **historical and superseded**. Current rates are prescribed from time to time by the Postal Directorate / Ministry of Finance.

Rules 366–371. Indents and Registers

- **Register:** the stationery account is maintained in **Form S.K.-8**.
- **Guard Books:** indented for **once in three years**.

Deadlines for stationery indents (Rule 371)

Indent Period Ending	Submit to Supdt. by	Submit to Store Depot by
30th September	10th February	25th February
31st March	10th August	25th August

Rules 378–381. Labels

- The indent notes, against each sample, the number of labels required bearing the name entered on it. Names of offices must be written **legibly**, spelt in accordance with the Classified List of Indian Post Offices and R.M.S. Offices and Sections.
- Both copies of the indent are submitted for **countersignature to the Superintendent**; the copy sent to the Stores Depot is the one with the samples attached.
- Timing: the indent must reach the Superintendent **not later than the 15th of each month**; his copies must reach the Circle Stores Depot **not later than the 1st of the following month**.
- Labels passed by the Superintendent are supplied **direct to the indenting record office**.
- Record clerks must indent **only for labels actually wanted** to replace damaged or unserviceable ones — they are not bound to indent when none is required.

Rules 382–383. Hand-Bags

Hand-bags supplied to Sorting Assistants, mail guards and van-peons are the **property of Government** and belong to the **Division** in which the holder is for the time being employed.

- On transfer, the holder makes over his bag to the record clerk of the Division he leaves, and receives the bag of the official he replaces in the new Division.

- Officials going on leave, dismissed, retiring, or ceasing to belong to the class must **return their bags**.
- The **date of issue** must be clearly and indelibly marked on every bag.

When a new bag may be demanded (Rule 383)

- (a) In use **not less than three years** — or **eighteen months** for bags made of old canvas; or
- (b) Lost, destroyed or damaged in circumstances **beyond control**, with a certificate by the Superintendent that he has personally ascertained the fact.

Holders are responsible for keeping bags serviceable for at least **three years**. Damage, loss or destruction through **carelessness or negligence** must be repaired or replaced **at the holder's own expense**.

NOTE TO RULE 383 — RESERVE STOCK

A **small reserve stock** of hand-bags may be kept at every record office to which candidates are attached, for issue when they travel with a section; the bags are returned when a candidate's duties no longer require travel. Indents for these must state the fact and the number of candidates attached.

Rules 384–385. Transfers of Surplus Articles of Stationery

- Articles found **in excess of an office's requirements** — owing to a change in the office's status or any other cause — may be transferred, **under the orders of the Superintendent**, to any other office requiring them.
- The order authorising the transfer **must be noted in the stationery register**.

Jurisdiction of Regional Forms Depots (Rule 292)

Depot	Circles Served
Aligarh	Delhi, J&K, Ambala (Haryana), Ludhiana (Punjab), Jaipur (Rajasthan), Lucknow (UP), Dehradun (Uttarakhand), Shimla (HP).
Nashik	Ahmedabad (Gujarat), Bengaluru (Karnataka), Mumbai (Maharashtra), Nagpur, Bhopal (MP), Raipur (Chhattisgarh).
Bhubaneswar	Hyderabad (Telangana), Vijayawada (AP), Patna (Bihar), Bhubaneswar (Odisha), Ranchi (Jharkhand).
Thrissur	Kochi, Chennai (Tamil Nadu), Madurai.
Kolkata	Kolkata (WB), Guwahati (Assam / NE), Silchar.

Specific Forms & Registers

- **Form Corr-22:** unimportant correspondence (with carbon paper).
- **Form Corr-40:** important correspondence.
- **Form S.K.-3 (Return):** invoice when returning articles to the Depot (in triplicate).
- **Form Genl-8A:** lease deed when non-residential departmental accommodation is let to a private person.

EXAM INSIGHT — CHAPTER VI FIGURES

Wastage 2% departmental / 10% public (15% selected large offices); Master Schedule reviewed every 5 years; emergent indents in triplicate, once a month; duplicate key parcel insured for Rs. 100; Guard Books once in 3 years; hand-bags 3 years (18 months old canvas); label indents by the 15th to Supdt., 1st to Depot.

B-2. Chapter VIII — Printing (Rules 405–417)

The rules governing what may be printed, who sanctions it, the authorised forms of the Department, classification of printing cost, printing at private presses, and the prohibition on unauthorised forms.

General Rules

Rule 405. The Governing Pamphlet

The general rules for printing and binding are found in the pamphlet **Rules for Printing and Binding, 1986 Edition**, issued by the Government of India, **Directorate of Printing, Ministry of Urban Development**.

UPDATE — THE MINISTRY HAS CHANGED

The **Directorate of Printing** is now an attached office of the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs** (the Ministry of Urban Development was merged into MoHUA in 2017). Under the Government of India (Allocation of Business) Rules 1961, the Directorate is the **Government Printer**, responsible for executing printing works for all Ministries / Departments including forms for Civil and Defence Departments. It is headed by the **Director of Printing**.

Flagged: no edition of the “Rules for Printing and Binding” later than 1986 has been traced. Quote the 1986 Edition as the Manual does, but verify before relying on it as current.

Rule 406. Prior Sanction of the Director-General

No **books, pamphlets or correction memos** (or such like matter) will be printed **without the prior sanction of the Director-General** — unless such printing has been authorised by general or special orders on the subject.

Rule 407. The Only Authorised Forms

The only printed forms authorised for general use in the Department are those given in:

- the **Book of Standard Printed Forms**; and
- the **Postal Books of Initial Account Forms**.

No new form can be introduced and no existing form altered **without the prior sanction of the Director-General**. The Director-General communicates with the **Manager, Government of India Forms Press, Aligarh**, regarding alterations to forms or the introduction of new or revised forms; that officer refers to the Director-General for orders when any standard form has to be printed.

UPDATE — THE ALIGARH FORMS PRESS

The Directorate of Printing currently operates only **five Government of India Presses**: New Delhi (Minto Road, Mayapuri and Rashtrapati Bhawan), Nashik (Maharashtra) and Kolkata (West Bengal). **Aligarh is not among them** — the Government of India Forms Press, Aligarh referred to in Rules 407 and 409 appears no longer to operate as a GIP under the Directorate.

Do not confuse two different Aligarh institutions: India Post's own **Postal Stores Depot, Aligarh** (Part A, para 4) **does still exist** and serves the northern Circles. The **Government of India Forms Press, Aligarh** belonged to the Directorate of Printing and is a separate body.

Flagged: the order closing or merging the Aligarh Forms Press, and the successor arrangement for standard-form printing, have not been traced. Confirm with the Directorate before treating Rules 407/409 as operationally current.

Rule 408. Notification of Changes

All alterations to forms, and the introduction and issue of new forms, are notified in the **Director General's circulars**.

Rule 409. Disposal of Existing Stock

Whenever it has been decided to alter or cancel an existing form, the Director-General issues orders to the Government of India Forms Press, Aligarh, regarding the disposal

of existing stock. **Ordinarily a new form will not be issued until the old stock has been used up.**

Rule 410. Size of Publications

All publications must be printed in **A-4 size** as far as practicable.

Classification

Rule 411. Two Classes

For purposes of the **Profit and Loss Account**, all orders to print new books, pamphlets and forms must indicate one or other of the following classes:

Class	Description
(1)	Postal
(2)	General (Postal)

Rule 412. Allocation of the Cost of Printing

The detailed rules for allocation of the cost of printing are found in the Chapter on miscellaneous subjects of the **P&T Financial Hand Book, Volume I**.

UPDATE — P&T FINANCIAL HAND BOOK

Following the bifurcation of the Posts and Telegraphs Department, the “P&T Financial Hand Book” is now the **Postal Financial Handbook (FHB) Volume I** — which is itself a separate item in the Paper II syllabus (S.No. 16, “Postal Financial Handbook Volume I and II”). Read the two together.

Printing at Private Presses

Rule 413. Rule 32 and the Local-Language Exception

The rules regarding printing at private presses are found in **Rule 32 of the Rules for Printing and Binding, 1986 Edition**.

However, **translations in local Indian languages** of notices announcing changes in rates, rules regarding abbreviated addresses, the deposit system etc. **may be printed at local presses by Heads of Circles**, provided the conditions laid down in that rule are fulfilled.

UPDATE — PROCUREMENT ROUTE

Any actual procurement of printing services today runs through the **General Financial Rules, 2017** and the **Government e-Marketplace (GeM)**, which replaced DGS&D. The Manual's permission in Rule 413 is about **who may authorise** local printing; the **how** is now governed by GFR 2017 + GeM and the CVC guidelines on public procurement (both named in the Paper I syllabus).

Printing and Publication under Orders of Government**Rule 414. Printing Must Be Done in India**

Printing and publication under the orders of Government — including the preparation of **plates, maps, etc.** required for illustration of works intended to be issued in India under their authority — **must, as a rule, be done in India**, except in special cases where there is good reason to the contrary. In such cases:

- the **prior sanction of the Controller of Printing and Stationery, India, New Delhi** must be obtained; and
- the **rates to be paid must be previously approved** by him.

UPDATE — THE DESIGNATION

“Controller of Printing and Stationery, India” is a historical designation. The Directorate of Printing is today headed by the **Director of Printing**, under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs; the Department of Publication handles publication. Quote the Manual's designation but know the current office.

Rules 415 & 416. Deleted

Both rules stand **deleted** in the Fourth Revised Edition. (A favourite one-liner: which rules of Chapter VIII are deleted? — **415 and 416.**)

Unauthorised Forms Prohibited**Rule 417. The Prohibition — and the One Exception**

The introduction of forms **other than those authorised by the Director-General is prohibited**. If the Head of a Circle considers the adoption of any special form necessary, he **must obtain the sanction of the Director-General** before introducing it.

NOTE TO RULE 417 — THE EXCEPTION

The Head of a Circle **may add questions to the standard forms of inspection report** to meet local requirements — without the DG's sanction. This is the single exception to Rule 417 and is heavily examined.

Chapter VIII — Ultra-Revision

- Chapter VIII = Rules 405–417 (415 and 416 deleted).
- Rule 405: governing pamphlet = Rules for Printing and Binding, 1986 Edition — Directorate of Printing (now under Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs, headed by the Director of Printing).
- Rule 406: no books / pamphlets / correction memos without the DG's prior sanction.
- Rule 407: only authorised forms = Book of Standard Printed Forms + Postal Books of Initial Account Forms; interface = Manager, GoI Forms Press, Aligarh.
- Rule 408: changes notified in the DG's circulars.
- Rule 409: new form not issued until old stock used up.
- Rule 410: publications printed in A-4 size as far as practicable.
- Rule 411: two classes for the Profit & Loss Account — (1) Postal, (2) General (Postal).
- Rule 412: cost allocation → P&T (now Postal) Financial Hand Book, Volume I.
- Rule 413: private presses → Rule 32 of the 1986 pamphlet; local-language notices may be printed locally by Heads of Circles.
- Rule 414: printing must as a rule be done in India; else prior sanction + rate approval of the Controller of Printing and Stationery (now Director of Printing).
- Rule 417: unauthorised forms prohibited; HoC needs DG's sanction — EXCEPT he may add questions to standard inspection report forms for local requirements.

B-3. Chapter IX — Contracts (Rules 418–431)

The definition of contract and piece-work, the fundamental principles of contracting, the responsibilities of officers who employ contractors, Earnest Money and Performance Security, and the standard mail-conveyance forms — read with the current GFR 2017.

Rule 418. Piece-work vs Contract

- **Piece-work:** work for which **only a rate is agreed upon**, without reference to the total quantity of work to be done, or the quantity to be done within a given period.
- **Contract:** all work done or supply made under agreement. The term as used in this Manual does **NOT** include agreements for execution of work by piece-work, nor more ordinary purchases of materials or stores.

Agreements should **invariably be in writing**, and should generally stipulate the **quantity** of work or material and the **time** within which it is to be completed.

Rule 419. Clarity of the Contract

Every contract must be framed so as to be **perfectly clear** and leave no doubt as to what has to be done, **specifying the dates on which the work is to be commenced and completed**. These particulars, with the rate or sum total agreed upon, are written in English and also, if possible, in the **local Indian language of the contractor**.

Rule 419/1. Seven Fundamental Principles of Contracting

1. The terms must be **precise and definite** — no room for ambiguity or misconstruction.
2. As far as possible, **legal and financial advice** should be taken in drafting, before contracts are finally entered into.
3. **Standard forms of contracts** should be adopted wherever possible, the terms subject to adequate prior scrutiny.
4. Terms once entered into **should not be materially varied** without the previous consent of the officer competent to accept the tender as so varied.
5. No contract involving **uncertain or indefinite liability**, or any condition of an unusual character, without the previous consent of the **competent financial authority**.
6. Whenever practicable and advantageous, contracts placed only after **tenders have been openly invited**; where the lowest tender is not accepted, **reasons must be recorded**.
7. In selecting the tender, the **financial status** of the individuals and firms tendering must be taken into consideration, in addition to all other relevant factors.

EXAM INSIGHT — RULE 419/1

These seven principles are the Manual's own restatement of the GFR contracting principles, and they map closely onto **GFR 2017 Rule 173 (fundamental principles**

of public buying). A question asking “which is NOT a principle under Rule 419/1” is easy marks if you know the list of seven.

Rule 420. Responsibilities

- **Officer responsibility:** employing a contractor does not relieve the officer in charge of responsibility for quality and timeliness.
- **Power to act:** every contract must give the officer full power to intervene if the contractor delays or fails to perform.
- **Monitoring:** a Register of Contracts is maintained in Circle, Divisional and First-Class Head Offices, reviewed **monthly** to identify contracts due to expire within the next 12 months.
- **Contract copies (Rule 420/2):** copies of contracts exceeding Rs. 50,000 furnished to the Audit Office for scrutiny.

Rule 427. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) / Bid Security

- **Requirement:** tenders accompanied by Earnest Money, generally **2% to 5%** of the estimated value of the goods.
- **Exemptions:** firms registered with the relevant authority (formerly DGS&D, now GeM), Micro & Small Enterprises (MSEs / erstwhile SSI units), or PSUs, to the extent provided in the rules.

VERIFIED — BID SECURITY UNDER GFR 2017

Under **Rule 170 of the GFR, 2017**, Bid Security (EMD) ensures a bidder does not withdraw or modify the bid during its validity; ordinarily **2% to 5%** of the estimated value, as fixed in the bidding documents. Separately, procuring entities now often take a **Bid Security Declaration** in lieu of EMD.

Source: GFR 2017, Rule 170 (Department of Expenditure).

Rule 430. Performance Security

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE — PERFORMANCE SECURITY %

The Manual mentions **3–5%**. Per the amendment to **Rule 171(i) of GFR, 2017** (MoF/DoE OM dated 01.01.2024, giving effect to OM No. 1/2/2023-PPD dated 03.04.2023), Performance Security for goods / consultancy / non-consultancy services has been modified from **5–10% to 3–10%** of the contract value.

For **procurement of works**, performance security plus security deposit / retention money continues to be **3% to 10%**. Performance Security normally remains valid for **60 days** beyond completion of all contractual obligations, including the warranty period.

Source: GFR 2017 Rule 171(i), as amended (DoE OM dated 01.01.2024).

Rule 431. Forms of Contract (Conveyance of Mails)

Form	Purpose
M-50	Conveyance of mails by wheeled carriages (animal-drawn).
M-50(a)	Conveyance of mails by motor vehicles in rural areas.
M-50(b)	Conveyance of mails by mazdoors, pack mules or ponies.
M-51	Revised agreement for conveyance of mails by motor vehicles.

MEMORY AID — THE M-50 FAMILY

Base M-50 = carts; (a) = rural motor; (b) = man / mule / pony; M-51 = revised motor agreement.

B-4. Chapter XII — Budget Estimates and Control

Budget Structure

The **Secretary (Department of Posts)** acts as the **Chief Accounting Authority**. The Budget Cell in each Circle is headed by the Chief Postmaster General and comprises two units:

- **Budget Control Unit (BCU):** located at the Postal Accounts Office (PAO).
- **Budget Operation Unit (BOU):** located at the Circle Office (CO).

Rule 756-A. Expenditure Classification

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE — PLAN VS NON-PLAN ABOLISHED

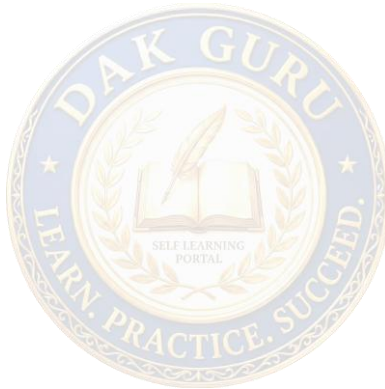
The distinction between “Plan” and “Non-Plan” expenditure was **phased out from the Union Budget of 2017-18** onwards. Expenditure is now classified as **Revenue and Capital**.

- **Revenue Expenditure:** (formerly “Non-Plan”) recurring, non-asset-creating — salaries, subsidies, interest.

- **Capital Expenditure:** (formerly “Plan”) productive, asset-creating purposes and projects.

FLAGGED — SCOPE OF CHAPTER XII

The official Chapter XII begins around **Rule 743** and is considerably wider than the budget material carried here (which came from the Dak Guru narrative booklet). The full chapter text should be worked through from the official Manual before the examination.



Part C | Office Procedure

Syllabus: Postal Manual Volume II — Chapter XI (Misc. Rules), read with the Manual of Office Procedure and the Annual Reports / Book of Information of D/o Posts.

Chapter XI — Miscellaneous Rules

National Observances & Protocol

- **National Week:** 6th to 13th April each year.
- **Flag display:** displayed in a straight line with other countries' flags, the National Flag is on the extreme right (observer's left); hoisted first and lowered last.
- **Anthems:** "Vande Mataram" at the beginning of a function; "Jana Gana Mana" at the end.

Rule 616. Use of Ink

Except where another colour is specifically prescribed, ink other than **blue** should not be used on official correspondence or records.

Rule 619. Salutation

In communications with officers of the Department, the subscription "**Yours faithfully**" should be used.

Rule 637. Filing System — Superintendent of Post Offices

File Head	Class of Correspondence
A	Establishment (creation / revision); opening and closing of offices and lines.
B	Personal matters (appointments, transfers, leave, punishments, service books).
C	Pensions and gratuities.
D	Buildings and runners' huts.
E	Accounts, TA, audit references.
F	Robberies, losses and frauds.
G	Mails (due lists, notices, business hours).
H	Experimental establishments.
I	Monsoon arrangements.
J	Indents and contingent expenditure.
K	Annual Report information.
L	Petty irregularities / miscellaneous.

Rule 637. Filing System — Superintendent of Railway Mail Service

File Head	Class of Correspondence
A	Procedure: general orders and rules on mails, unregistered articles, station bundles (paid / unpaid), registered articles / bundles.
B	Personal: appointments, leave, punishments, pensions, gratuities, security bonds, service books, character sheets, gradation lists.
C	Establishment: creation / revision / abolition of establishments, proposition statements, distribution lists.
D	Sorting: sorting lists, due-bag statements, sorting mail offices, transit sections, special orders.
E	Distribution of work: arrangement of work in offices / vans / sections, changes in jurisdiction / beats, opening and closing of sections.
F	Accommodation: mail vans and buildings (construction, repair, references).
G	Conveyance of mails: new lines, time-tables, train detention / misconnection, accidents, mail-steamer notices.
H	Stock: general stock rules, stationery rate list, supply of bags / forms, uniforms, indents.
J	Accounts: general accounts, permanent advances, fixed contingent allowances, audit references.
K	Investigations: robberies, losses, frauds and serious irregularities.
M	Camp articles: movement of high officers and disposal of camp articles.
Z	Miscellaneous: minor irregularities (bags, bundles) and matters not included elsewhere.

KEY DISTINCTION – THE TWO FILING SYSTEMS

Postal (SPOs) and RMS (SRM) use **parallel but different** heads. Traps: in the Postal list **C = Pensions**; in the RMS list **C = Establishment** and pensions sit under B. The RMS list has **no I or L**, but adds **M (camp articles)** and **Z (miscellaneous)**.

Rule 666. Service Postage

- No personal communication from a departmental official may be sent free “On Service”.
- **Penalty: double the charges** that should have been paid, recovered by means of postage stamps.

Rule 666. Handling of Personal Files & Leave Papers

- Transfer exceeding 3 months to another Circle, Division or Office → personal file forwarded in a **Service Registered Cover**.
- **Casual leave papers** must not form part of the permanent personal file; destroyed at the end of each year and a fresh series started.

Rule 694-C. Postal Circle Maps

A skeleton postal map of the Circle is submitted to the Director General in **June** each year, incorporating all corrections of the past year.

Rule 708. Alphabetical List of Post Offices

- **Main edition:** September. **Supplementary:** April of the following year.

Rule 696. Annual Reports

- **To the Head of Circle:** by 1st May. **To the Director General:** before 16th June.

Rule 721. Identity Cards

The normal life of a departmental Identity Card (**Form Ms-95**) is **4 years**.

EXAM INSIGHT — CHAPTER XI DATES & FIGURES

Circle map → June. Alphabetical List → September (supplementary April). Annual Report → HoC by 1 May, DG before 16 June. Identity Card → 4 years. National Week → 6–13 April. Service-postage breach → double the charges. Ink → blue. Salutation → “Yours faithfully”.

Ultra-Revision | Paper I High-Yield

- DoP = 1 of 2 Departments under the Ministry of Communications (other = DoT).
- PSB = Chairperson + 7 Members (Personnel, Operations, Technology, Financial Services, HRD, Infrastructure, Service Quality & Marketing). Permanent invitee = AS & FA.
- 23 territorial Circles + Base Circle (APS) = 24. ADG APS = Major General; other ranks 75% DoP : 25% Army.
- PSDs (5): Aligarh, Nashik, Bhubaneswar, Thrissur, Kolkata. Security presses (2): Nashik, Hyderabad. RLOs (4): Kolkata, Mumbai, Lucknow, Chennai.
- RAKNPA Ghaziabad + 6 PTCs (Guwahati, Vadodara, Mysuru, Madurai, Saharanpur, Darbhanga).
- Post Office Act 2023 in force 18.06.2024 (no offences); Post Office Rules 2024 in force 16.12.2024 supersede the Indian Post Office Rules 1933.
- Ch VI Stock = Rules 269–385 and INCLUDES stationery (341-A–385) — there is no 'Chapter 7'.
- Stock Book S.K.-1; Bags S.K.-1(a); Forms S.K.-1(b); Stationery account S.K.-8; Emergent indent S.K.-2 / Genl.-18 in triplicate.
- Wastage: 2% departmental / 10% public (15% selected large offices); Master Schedule reviewed every 5 years.
- Guard Books once in 3 years; hand-bags 3 years (18 months old canvas); duplicate key parcel insured Rs. 100.
- Stationery indents: period ending 30 Sept → Supdt by 10 Feb, Depot by 25 Feb; period ending 31 Mar → 10 Aug / 25 Aug.
- Ch VIII Printing = 405–417; 415 & 416 DELETED; A-4 size (410); classes = Postal / General (Postal) (411).
- Rule 417: unauthorised forms prohibited — but HoC MAY add questions to standard inspection report forms.
- Ch IX: piece-work = rate only; contract = quantity + time, in writing. Rule 419/1 = seven fundamental principles.
- EMD 2–5% (GFR Rule 170); Performance Security now 3–10% (GFR Rule 171(i) as amended, DoE OM 01.01.2024); valid 60 days beyond obligations.
- Register of Contracts reviewed monthly (expiry within 12 months); contract copies > Rs. 50,000 to Audit Office.

- M-50 carts; M-50(a) rural motor; M-50(b) mazdoor/mule/pony; M-51 revised motor.
- Budget: Secretary (Posts) = Chief Accounting Authority; BCU at PAO, BOU at CO; Plan/Non-Plan abolished from 2017-18 → Revenue/Capital.
- Office procedure: ink blue; 'Yours faithfully'; ID card (Ms-95) 4 years; Circle map June; Annual Report HoC 1 May / DG 16 June.



Verification & Source Note

Primary sources — the Manual

- Postal Manual Volume II, Fourth Revised Edition (Director General Posts) — official text. Preface confirms 11 Chapters + 13 Appendices and that Chapter II is deleted. Chapter VI runs to Rule 385 (stationery included); Chapter VII begins at Rule 386; Chapter VIII = Rules 405–417; Chapter IX begins at Rule 418; Chapter XII begins around Rule 743.

Syllabus authority

- DoP letter No. 9-04/2018-SPG-II dated 05.09.2019, as corrected by the corrigendum of the same number dated 30.12.2019. A Directorate communication of August 2022 proposed further amendment; no superseding syllabus traced as issued.

Primary sources — current law verified

- India Post — “Our Organisation”, www.indiapost.gov.in (Board composition; 23 Circles; Secretary and DG shown as distinct office-holders).
- Post Office Act, 2023 (Act 43 of 2023) — in force 18.06.2024; 16 sections; no offences. Post Office Rules, 2024 (G.S.R. 767(E)) — in force 16.12.2024, superseding the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933.
- GFR 2017 Rule 170 (Bid Security 2–5%) and Rule 171(i) as amended by DoE OM dated 01.01.2024 (Performance Security 3–10%).
- Directorate of Printing — attached office of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs; Government Printer under the Allocation of Business Rules 1961; headed by the Director of Printing; operates five Government of India Presses — New Delhi (Minto Road, Mayapuri, Rashtrapati Bhawan), Nashik and Kolkata.
- Union Budget 2017-18 — Plan / Non-Plan classification discontinued.

This material is a study aid only and does not constitute an official or legal publication. The original Postal Manual Vol II, the relevant Rules and the latest Government of India notifications shall always prevail.